

The Analects (論語)

Confucius (孔子) · James
Legge (1893)

Book III — 八佾 (Ba Yi)

子曰：「人而不仁，如禮何？人而不仁，如樂何？」

The Master said, 'If a man be without the virtues proper to humanity, what has he to do with the rites of propriety? If a man be without the virtues proper to humanity, what has he to do with music?'

子貢欲去告朔之餼羊。子曰：「賜也！爾愛其羊，我愛其禮。」

Tsze-kung wished to do away with the offering of a sheep connected with the inauguration of the first day of each month. The Master said, 'Ts'ze, you love the sheep; I love the ceremony.'

子曰：「居上不寬，為禮不敬，臨喪不哀，吾何以觀之哉？」

The Master said, 'High
station filled without
indulgent generosity;
ceremonies performed
without reverence;
mourning conducted
without sorrow; —
wherewith should I
contemplate such ways?'

Translation by James Legge,
The Chinese Classics, vol. 1
(Oxford: Clarendon Press,

1893). This translation is in the public domain.